



Keyboard
App Builder

Installing and Building Apps on a Mac



Keyboard App Builder: Installing and Building Apps on a Mac

© 2021, SIL International

Last updated: 25 March 2025

You are free to print this manual for personal use and for training workshops.

The latest version is available at
<http://software.sil.org/keyboardappbuilder/resources/>

and on the Help menu of Keyboard App Builder.

Contents

1. Introduction 5

2. Installing Keyboard App Builder 5

3. Installing Prerequisites for Android 5

3.1. Java Development Kit (JDK) 5

3.2. Installing Android Software Development Kit (SDK) 7

3.2.1. Downloading the Android SDK packages from the internet 7

3.2.2. Copying the Android SDK files from someone else 9

4. Installing Prerequisites for iOS 10

4.1. Install Xcode 10

4.2. Verify Xcode Installation 10

4.3. Install Transporter 11

5. Building a Keyboard App for iOS 11

5.1. Apple Development Store Setup 11

5.1.1. Enroll in the Apple Developer Program 11

5.1.2. Create Signing Certificate 12

5.1.3. Create App Identifiers 13

5.1.4. Create App Group 14

5.1.5. Associate App Identifiers to App Group 14

5.1.6. Create Provisioning Profiles 15

5.2. Building iOS App using Keyboard App Builder 15

5.2.1. IPA Tab 15

5.2.2. Signing (iOS) Tab 17

5.2.3. Build iOS App 20

5.2.4. Run iOS App in Simulator 20

6. Building from Terminal 21

6.1. Installing Command Line Interface 21

6.2. Command Line Interface Options 22

1. Introduction

This document provides information on how to install Keyboard App Builder and build apps on an Apple macOS system. Creating an Android app on a Mac is essentially the same process as it is for Windows or Linux.

Keyboard App Builder only builds apps for Android. There is currently no iOS app.

2. Installing Keyboard App Builder

To install the Keyboard App Builder program files:

1. Download the current Mac installer file (dmg) from the KAB website:
<http://software.sil.org/keyboardappbuilder/download/>
2. Double click on the file within **Finder** to open the disk image that contains the Keyboard App Builder application.
3. Copy the **Keyboard App Builder** application to your **Application** folder. This can be done by dragging the Keyboard App Builder icon from the disk image window to the shortcut of the Applications folder in the same window.

3. Installing Prerequisites for Android

If you want to build Android apps, you need to install the following components on your computer:

1. Java Development Kit (JDK)
2. Android Software Development Kit (SDK)

3.1. Java Development Kit (JDK)

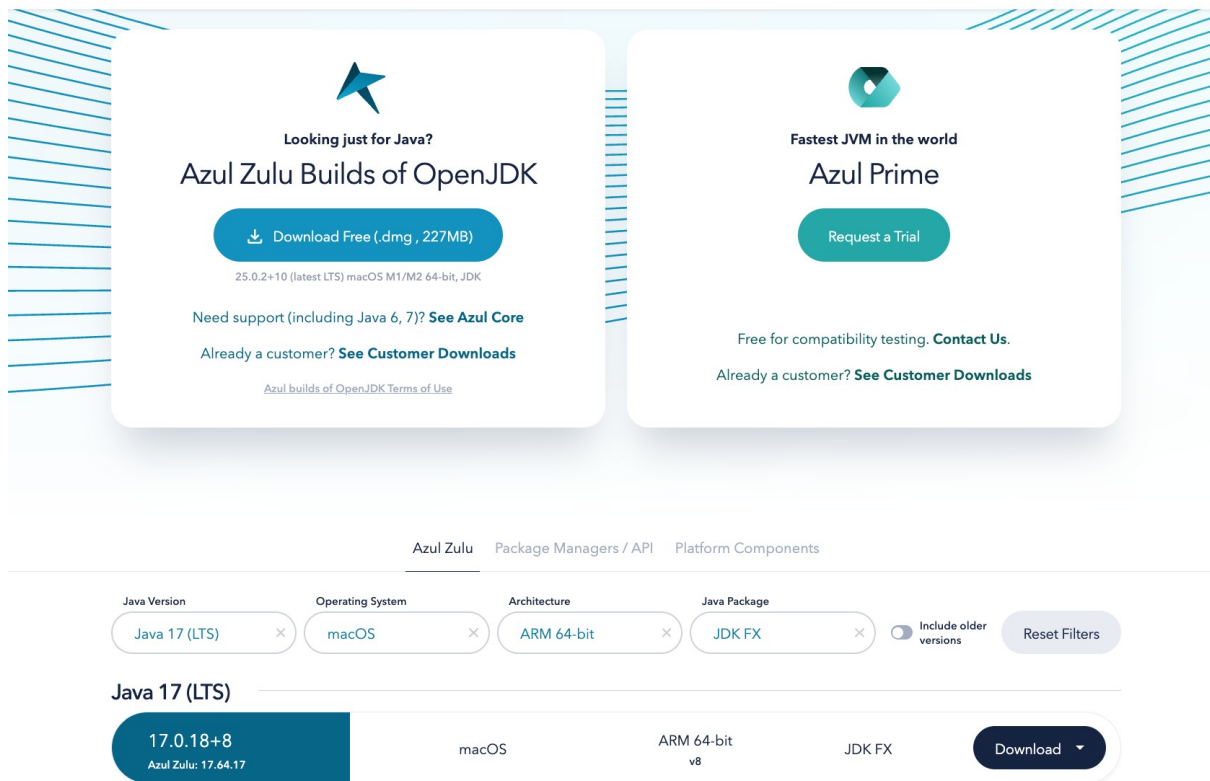
You will need version 17 of the Java Development Kit (JDK) to build apps. We recommend you use Zulu, which is a free distribution of OpenJDK from Azul.

1. Go to the **Download Zulu Builds of OpenJDK** website:

<https://www.azul.com/downloads/?version=java-17-lts&os=macos&architecture=arm-64-bit&package=jdk-fx#zulu>

There are many downloads on this page, but the above link will filter the ones you see (Java Version: Java 17 LTS; Operating System: MacOS; Architecture: ARM 64-bit; Java Package: Java FX).

2. Scroll down the page until you see the downloads under the heading **Download Azul Zulu Builds of OpenJDK:**



1. You have a choice between two different architectures: **x86 64-bit** and **ARM 64-bit**. You can find the processor type of your machine by clicking on the Apple symbol at the top left of your screen and selecting **About This Mac**. If you have an older Mac running with an Intel x86 chip, select x86 (64 bit) otherwise you will need the ARM 64-bit.

Once you have identified your device architecture, you have a choice between a **dmg** file, a **tar.gz** file and a **zip** file. **Download the .dmg file** since it comes with its own installer program.

The file you download will have a filename something like this:

zulu17.64.17-ca-fx-jdk17.0.18-macosx_x64.dmg

2. **Double-click the file in Finder** and follow the instructions in the installation wizard to install it. By default, the installer will install the JDK to the following folder:

/Library/Java/JavaVirtualMachines/zulu-17.jdk/Contents/Home

Important: If you change the JDK install folder to something other than the default folder, you will need to remember the location of the folder so you can tell Keyboard App Builder where to find the JDK.

3.2. Installing Android Software Development Kit (SDK)

The Android Software Development Kit (SDK) is needed for building Android apps. There are two ways of installing the Android SDK:

1. **Online: Download the Android SDK packages from the internet:**
Use the Android SDK Installation wizard to download and install the command line tools and three additional packages. This method will require an internet connection.
See 3.2.1 for more details.
2. **Offline: Copy the Android SDK files from someone else:**
If you know someone who has already downloaded and installed the Android SDK, you can copy all the files from them.

This method is especially useful in a training workshop where several people need to install the SDK but have limited internet bandwidth.

See 3.2.2 for more details.

3.2.1. Downloading the Android SDK packages from the internet

To install the Android SDK from the internet:

1. Launch **Keyboard App Builder**.
2. Select **Keyboard App Builder Ø Preferences** from the main menu.
3. Go to the **Android SDK** tab, which is the second tab.

4. Click the **Install Android SDK** button.



5. Follow the instructions on each page of the **Install Android SDK** wizard to download each of the Android SDK packages and install them.

When you are asked to specify a target folder, a good place is:
/Users/your-name/Android-SDK.

Four packages will be downloaded and installed:

- Command line tools,
- Build Tools,
- Platform Tools, and
- Platform API.

If the installation was successful, you will see the version numbers displayed in green.



If any of the Build Tools, Platform Tools or Platform API is listed as “Not Found” (displayed in red), click the **Install Packages** button to install them.

Click the **Check Installation** button to confirm that all the packages have been installed correctly.

3.2.2. Copying the Android SDK files from someone else

If you know someone who has already downloaded and installed the Android SDK and is successfully building apps with it, you can copy all of their Android SDK files to a folder on your computer.

You need to look for the top-level Android SDK folder, such as **/Users/user-name/Android-SDK**, and copy the whole folder and its contents to your computer. A location such as **/Users/your-name/Android-SDK** is good. If it makes it easier, you can zip the folders and then unzip them onto your computer.

Note that there is no setup program to run. Copying the files from one computer to another is sufficient.

Tip: A typical Android SDK folder can be quite large (over 1 GB, depending on which additional packages have been installed). To build an app, you do not actually need all of the

Android SDK files. If you want to cut down the number of files, here is a list of the essential and optional folders:

Android SDK Folder	Required for building apps?
cmdline-tools (or tools)	Yes
build-tools	Yes (you only need the sub-folder for the latest version)
platforms	Yes (you only need android-30 for now)
platform-tools	Yes
add-ons	No
docs	No
emulator	No, unless you want to use an emulator
extras	No
licenses	Yes
sources	No
system-images	No, unless you want to use an emulator
temp	No

4. Installing Prerequisites for iOS

If you want to build iOS apps and upload them to the Apple App Store, you need to install the following components:

1. **Xcode**
2. **Transporter**

4.1. Install Xcode

Xcode is required to build iOS Apps. To install Xcode, simply search for Xcode in the Mac App Store and install it. Open Xcode at least once to agree to the licensing restrictions and install components.



4.2. Verify Xcode Installation

To verify that you have successfully installed Xcode and that it will be correctly used by Scripture App Builder, please open Terminal and run the following command to print the path to the active developer directory: `xcode-select -p`

```
$ xcode-select -p
/Applications/Xcode.app/Contents/Developer
```

If you have had Xcode Command-line Tools installed previously, it might still be pointing to that installation directory and Scripture App Builder will not work correctly.

```
$ xcode-select -p  
/Library/Developer/CommandLineTools
```

To correct this situation, run the following command to set the active developer directory.

```
sudo xcode-select -s /Applications/Xcode.app/Contents/Developer
```

4.3. Install Transporter

Transporter is used to upload iOS apps to App Store Connect. To install Transporter, simply search for Transporter in the Mac App Store and install it.



5. Building a Keyboard App for iOS

The process for building an Android App on a Mac follows the steps laid out in *the Keyboard App Builder 02 Building Apps* document. Building one for iOS has several additional considerations, including getting provisioning profiles for app.

5.1. Apple Development Store Setup

5.1.1. Enroll in the Apple Developer Program

To build iOS apps and distribute them through the Apple App Store, you will need to be enrolled in the Apple Developer Program. You can do this as either (i) an individual, or (ii) an organisation. The cost is USD \$99 per year.

To enroll:

1. Go to <https://developer.apple.com/programs/enroll/>
2. Press the **Start Your Enrollment** button to start.

5.1.2. Create Signing Certificate

When you create an iOS app, it needs to be signed with a certificate.

To create a certificate:

1. Go to the [Apple Developer](https://developer.apple.com) website and log in to your account if you are not already.
2. Select **Certificates, Identifiers & Profiles**.
3. Click the  button to the right of the **Certificates** header.
4. On the **Create a New Certificate** page, select **Apple Distribution**. Then press the **Continue** button.
5. Upload a Certificate Signing Request. Press the **Learn more** link for instructions on how to use Keychain Access on your Mac computer to complete this task. Then press the **Continue** button.
6. On the **Download Your Certificate** page, press the **Download** button to download the certificate (distribution.cer) to your Mac.
7. Open the Keychain Access application. Choose the **login** item from the Keychains section on the left. Choose the **File ▾ Import Items...** menu item and browse to the Downloads folder and select the certificate (distribution.cer).

Now that the certificate is installed in the Keychain, you will be able to access it from within Scripture App Builder.

Note: To work with certificates, you will need the Apple Worldwide Developer Relations (WWDR) Certification Authority. It should have been installed with Xcode. When viewing your certificate in the Keychain Access application, if there is an error stating the certificate is not trusted, then install the certification authority.

To get the certification authority:

1. Download the Apple WWDR Certification Authority from:
<https://developer.apple.com/certificationauthority/AppleWWDRCA.cer>
For signing certificates created after January 28, 2021:
<https://www.apple.com/certificateauthority/AppleWWDRCA3.cer>
2. Open the Keychain Access application. Choose the **System** item from the Keychains section on the left. Choose the **File ▾ Import Items...** menu item and browse to the Downloads folder and select the certification authority (AppleWWDRCA.cer). You will be prompted for a username and password that has admin privileges in order to modify the **System** Keychain.
3. Choose the **File ▾ Lock Keychain "System"** menu item.

5.1.3. Create App Identifiers

First, select an app package name as described in section 4.1 of the *Building Apps* document. Log into the Apple Developer web site and select *Identifiers*. You will need to add two new identifiers to support your keyboard app, both belonging to a common unique group. For this example, a package name of *org.sil.kabtest* will be used.

For an iOS keyboard app, a second identifier is required to support the app extension that runs when a keyboard is used by another app. This identifier must be the original app package name with “.swkeyboard” appended to the end. So for this example, the second identifier will have a bundle ID of *org.sil.kabtest.swkeyboard*”.

These steps should be followed to create the app identifiers for this app:

1. Press the “+” sign at the top of the identifiers list to create a new identifier.
2. The next screen should say “Register a new identifier” and App Ids should already be selected. Press “Continue”.
3. The next screen says “Register a new identifier” with options of “App” or “App Clip” with “App” selected. Press “Continue”
4. The “Register an App ID” screen is displayed next. You must fill out the *Description* field with a description of your choice. The *Bundle ID* field should be completed using the app package name (for our example: *org.sil.kabtest*). In the capabilities section, App Groups must be enabled. The following screen shot shows a completed entry:

< All Identifiers

Register an App ID

Back Continue

Platform
iOS, iPadOS, macOS, tvOS, watchOS, visionOS

App ID Prefix
3YE4W86L3G (Team ID)

Description
Keyboard Test App
You cannot use special characters such as @, &, *, " ,

Bundle ID ☒ Explicit ☐ Wildcard
sil.org.kabtest
We recommend using a reverse-domain name style string (i.e., com.domainname.appname). It cannot contain an asterisk (*).

Capabilities App Services

ENABLE	NAME	NOTES
☐	5G Network Slicing ⓘ	
☐	Access Wi-Fi Information ⓘ	
☐	App Attest ⓘ	
☒	App Groups ⓘ	

5. Press “Continue”. A confirmation screen appears with the information you have entered. Verify that you have entered the Bundle Id correctly and that App Groups is checked. Then press “Register”.
6. Repeat steps 1-5 using the keyboard bundle ID (example: *org.sil.kabtest.swkeyboard*) to create the second identifier for the app.

5.1.4. Create App Group

Both of the identifiers that have been created must belong to the same group. The group identifier that will be created must use your app package name with “group.” appended to the front. For our example, we will create an app group with identifier *group.org.sil.kabtest*.

Start at the Identifiers list page, which is the same page that you started *Section 5.1.3* from. Follow these steps to create the app group:

1. Press the “+” sign at the top of the identifiers list to create a new identifier.
2. The next screen displays “Register a new identifier” and “App IDs” should be selected. Change the selection to “App Groups”. Press “Continue”
3. The “Register an App Group” screen displays next. Fill the *Description* field with a description of your choice. Typing in the identifier will automatically start with *group*. So type in your package name to complete the group identifier (example *org.sil.kabtest* to create *group.org.sil.kabtest*). The following screen shot shows a completed entry:

< All Identifiers

Register an App Group

Back Continue

Description

Keyboard Test App Group

You cannot use special characters such as @, &, *, ', ', -, .

Identifier

group.org.sil.kabtest

We recommend using a reverse-domain name style string (i.e., com.domainname.appname).

4. Press “Continue”. A confirmation screen appears with the information you have entered. Verify that the identifier is entered correctly and press “Register”.

5.1.5. Associate App Identifiers to App Group

When you created the app identifiers, the App Groups capability was enabled, but there was no option at that point to set the group. This must now be configured for both of the two app identifiers which were created.

Start at the identifiers list page. If “App IDs” is not selected on the right, change the selection so that the list of app identifiers is displayed.

1. Find the entry for your first identifier and select it. (Example: *org.sil.kabtest*)
2. The “Edit your App ID Configuration” screen will be displayed. Beside the checked “App Groups” entry, there will now be a “Configure” button. Press the “Configure” button.
3. A list of the current group definitions will appear. Check the one that was created in the previous step for this app (*group.org.sil.kabtest*) and press “Continue”.

4. This will return you to the “Edit your App ID Configuration” screen. The “Configure” button has been replaced with an “Edit” button and it should display “Enabled App Groups (1)”. Press “Save”.
5. A warning screen will display, press “Confirm”
6. The identifier list page should be redisplayed. Repeat steps 1-5 for the keyboard identifier (Example: *org.sil.kabtest.swkeyboard*) associating it with the same group (*group.org.sil.kabtest*) as the first identifier. So when this step is complete, both identifiers will be associated with the same group.

5.1.6. Create Provisioning Profiles

Provisioning profiles must be created for both of the applications that were registered. For publishing to the App Store, the app should be signed with profiles for the App Store. Within the Apple Developer website, navigate to the “Profiles” section. Use the following steps to create the required provisioning profiles:

1. From the “Profiles” page, press the “+” button to create a new profile.
2. The “Register a New Provisioning Profile” screen will display. Select “App Store” as the type of profile to be created and press the “Continue” button.
3. The screen to select an app id displays. Select the app id that was created for the app package name in section 5.1.3. (Example: *org.sil.kabtest*). Press “Continue”.
4. The Certificate Selection screen will display next. Display a distribution certificate for your organization and press “Continue”.
5. The next screen asks for a name for the certificate. Add an appropriate name for the profile to be created and press “Generate”.
6. After the profile has been generated, the “Download and Install” screen displays. Press the “Download” button to copy the profile to your local Mac.
7. Repeat steps 1-6 to generate a provisioning profile for the keyboard app id (example: “org.sil.kabtest.swkeyboard”)

5.2. Building iOS App using Keyboard App Builder

Most of the setup for building an app using Keyboard App Builder is described in the *the Keyboard App Builder 02 Building Apps*. This section will discuss the specific sections that are required for an iOS app.

5.2.1. IPA Tab

The **IPA Tab** contains the information needed by the builder to produce the IPA file, which is the final product of the builder. The IPA file is what you will send to the Apple App Store to publish.



The **Filename** field on the screen for the **IPA File** section specifies the base name of the ipa file to be generated. If the checkbox at the bottom of the screen for *Append version name to ipa filename* is checked, then the version indicated by the *Version Name* fields is added to the base filename.

The **Build** field referenced as *Build* is also called *Bundle Version String*, *Bundle Version* or *CFBundleVersion* within Xcode and iTunes Connect. It represents the build number. The *Build* field expects an integer value and should be incremented with each file that is submitted to the iTunes Connect for release or testing.

The **Version Name** field is referenced as *Version*, *Bundle Short Version String*, *Bundle versions string, short* and *CFBundleShortVersionString* within Xcode and iTunes Connect. The field is created as a concatenation of the values of the three fields separated by a period. If the final field has a value of 0, then the version string is created from just the first two values. For values of 1, 2 and 0, the resulting string is "1.2". For values of 1, 2 and 3, the resulting version string is "1.2.3".

The **Apple ID** field is the id assigned by App Store Connect to the application in the app store. It can be obtained from **Apple ID** filed on the App Information tab in the App Store Connect entry for the app as shown below

The screenshot shows the 'App Information' tab in App Store Connect for the app 'KAB Template App'. The interface includes a top navigation bar with 'App Store Connect' and various tool tabs. A left sidebar lists navigation options under 'General' and 'Features'. The main content area is divided into 'Localizable Information' and 'General Information' sections. In 'Localizable Information', the 'Name' field is set to 'KAB Template App' and the 'Subtitle' field is empty. In 'General Information', the 'Bundle ID' is 'Keyboard Template App - org.sil.kbdtemplate', the 'SKU' is 'KbdTemplateApp', and the 'Apple ID' is '6469634585'. The 'Primary Language' is 'English (U.S.)' and the 'Category' is 'Primary'.

The **Bundle ID** section allows the user to specify a Bundle ID for the app that is different than the package name. By default, the **Package Name** field from the **Package** tab is used as the Application Bundle ID that is used in creating the provisioning profiles and as the application identifier for the Apple App Store. If the user wants the iOS version of the app to have an identifier that is different than the package name that is used for the Android version of the app, press the **Specify a Bundle ID** button and then enter the ID to be used in the text box labelled **Bundle ID**.

5.2.2. Signing (iOS) Tab

The **Signing (iOS)** tab is used to identify the certificate and provisioning profiles that the builder will require to sign the app in creating the IPA file.

Test KAB: App

App Name	Package	Project	APK	IPA	Signing (Android)	Signing (iOS)	Expiry	Security	Permissions
----------	---------	---------	-----	-----	-------------------	---------------	--------	----------	-------------

Please specify the signing identity and provisioning profile to configure this app for iOS.

Signing Identity

The signing identity is used to sign the app with a certificate so that users will know that the app can be trusted and has not been tampered with.

Identity

Expires Feb 9 18:36:37 2024 GMT

Provisioning Profile

The provisioning profile is used to associate the app with specific iOS devices, such as your device and others who are on your app development and testing team. You can download this file from the Apple Developer Portal.

Profile File

Extension App Provisioning Profile

The provisioning profile for the extension app packaged with the keyboard app. This profile is used to associate the app with specific iOS devices, such as your device and others who are on your app development and testing team. You can download this file from the Apple Developer Portal.

Profile File

Select the **Signing Identity** from the drop down list of signing certificates which have been downloaded and installed to this system in the earlier steps. The certificate must match the signing certificate that was specified when building the provisioning profiles in the *Create Provisioning Profiles* section above.

For the **Provisioning Profile** entry, enter or browse to the mobile provisioning file that associated with the main app (example: *org.sil.kabtest*) in the *Create Provisioning Profiles* section above

For the **Extension App Provisioning Profile** entry, enter or browse to the mobile provisioning file that was associated with the keyboard app (example: *org.sil.kabtest.swkeyboard*) in the *Create Provisioning Profiles* section above.

Each of the provisioning profiles has a **Details** button. Once a provisioning file has been selected, pressing this button will display the details associated with the selected file. It will identify the type of the profile (Appstore, adHoc or development), the app id and team id used to create the app, and the list of entitlements associated with the app. For an adHoc or development profile, it will provide a list of the ids of all devices that are registered as eligible devices for this profile. Below are a couple of examples of the **Details** display:

5.2.3. Build iOS App

Click on the **Build iOS App** button at the top of the screen. A window will open which will display a log for the build script that is run to produce the iOS App.



Examine the log window once the script has been completed. The message “Signed release IPA build successfully.” should appear in the window if the app has been build successfully.

The results of the build are an IPA file and an app that can be run in the simulator. They can be found in ~/App Builder/Keyboard Apps/Ipa Output/ and ~/App Builder/Keyboard Apps/Sim Output/.

5.2.4. Run iOS App in Simulator

This option is similar to the **Build iOS App** button but only produces the simulator app. It does not generate the ipa file for the app store. Click on the **Run iOS App in Simulator** button at the top of the screen. A dialog will pop up.



Pressing the **Start** button will start an instance of the iPhone simulator installed with XCode.

The **Project Name** drop down will initially be set to the name of the current project selected within KAB. If you want to build a different project, select the project from the drop down list of available projects.

The **Build** button will trigger a build of the app for the simulator and will display a window similar to the one for the **Build iOS App**. Any error that are encountered will be displayed in the log window. If everything is successful, a message: "Copying sim to output folder" should appear near the end of the log.

Open Output Folder will open a Finder window for the ~/App Builder/Keyboard Apps/Sim Output/ folder where the generated simulator apps are located. The app may be installed to the simulator by dragging it from Finder to the Simulator window. ***Due to coding limitations, only one keyboard app may be installed to a simulator instance at one time for testing. More than one KAB app will result in unpredictable results.***

6. Building from Terminal

Keyboard App Builder has a command line interface which allows you to create a new app and build it or load an existing app and build it.

6.1. Installing Command Line Interface

Choose the **Tools** ➤ **Install kab command in PATH** menu item to enable the use of the command line interface. You will be prompted to enter your login password to install the command.

6.2. Command Line Interface Options

Run the following command to run the Keyboard App Builder application followed by a series of options described below. The command is:

`kab`

The available parameters are:

Option	Description
-new	Create a new app project
-load <project>	Load an existing app project
-build	Build app project (use with either -new or -load)
-no-save	Do not save changes to app (use with -load)
-resign	Resign iOS Template App (use with either -new or -load)
-?	Show command line help
-n <app-name>	Set app name. Enclose the name in "double quotes" if it contains spaces.
-p <package-name>	Set package name, e.g. com.myorg.language.appname
-b <filename>	Add book or bundle file. This could be a USFM file or a zipped set of USFM files. It could also be a Digital Bible Library text release bundle.
-i <filename>	Include additional parameters file. Use the full path of the file and enclose it in "double quotes" if there is a space in the path.
-a <filename>	Set about box text, contained in text file. Use the full path of the file and enclose it in "double quotes" if there is a space in the path.
-f <fontname>	Set font name or filename, e.g. "Charis SIL Compact", "c:\fonts\myfont.ttf" The font name must be one of the items in the list of fonts in the New App wizard. For other fonts, specify the full path to the font filename.

-g	Use Grandroid
-ic <filename>	Add launcher icon (one or more .png files). Use the full path of the files and enclose them in "double quotes" if there is a space in the path.
-l <lang-code>	Set language for menu items and settings, e.g. en, fr, es
-ft <feature=value>	Set a feature, e.g. book-select=grid
-vc <integer>	Set version code, e.g. 1, 2, 3, or +1 to increment the current version code by 1.
-vn <string>	Set version name, e.g. 1.0, 2.1.4, or use +1, +0.1, +0.0.1 to increment the current value.
-ks <filename>	Set keystore filename. Use the full path of the file and enclose it in "double quotes" if there is a space in the path.
-ksp <password>	Set keystore password
-ka <alias>	Set key alias
-kap <password>	Set key alias password
-fp <folder=path>	Set a folder path, e.g. "app.builder=/Developer/Reading App Builder".
-ta <target-api>	Set Target API, e.g. 21 for Android 5.0, 22 for Android 5.1.
-si <signing identity>	Set Signing Identity to use for iOS Resigning
-pp <provisioning profile>	Set full path to provisioning profile for iOS resigning
-bn <integer>	Set build number for ipa file, e.g. 1, 2, 3, or +1 to increment by 1
-vs <string>	Set version string for ipa file, e.g. 1.0, 2.1.4 or +1, +0.1, +0.0.1

Examples:

```
kab -load "Mali" -resign -bn "5" -vs "2.3.2" -si "iPhone Distribution: Summer
Institute of Linguistics, Inc (SIL) (4YF5X97M4H) " -pp
```

```
"/Users/builder/Documents/MobileProvision/AdHoc_org.wycliffe.app.mali.mobileprovisi  
on"
```

Running the command line with no parameters will start the Keyboard App Builder UI from the command line.